Case Study

Secure Flexibility and Prompt Precision – How TODD Handles Siloed Departments

Client Background

A large state agency responsible for workforce development, education funding, and policy enforcement approached Taliferro Group with a challenge: different departments needed access to AI assistance, but their data could not be shared across units. The legal team operated under confidentiality mandates, the finance team managed sensitive budget forecasts, and the outreach division handled community data that had to stay protected. Despite these silos, leadership wanted all departments to benefit from AI-enhanced workflows—without compromising data integrity.

Challenges

The agency faced four main challenges:

- **Strict Data Silos**: Legal, Finance, Outreach, and HR departments operated in data isolation by policy and necessity.

- **Inflexible AI Tools**: Off-the-shelf GenAI tools like Microsoft Co-pilot lacked the ability to enforce hard separation between user groups.
- **Prompt Inaccuracy**: Staff struggled to get reliable, actionable results from general-purpose tools, wasting time refining AI output.
- **Lack of Customization**: One-size-fits-all solutions didn't allow departments to tailor the AI to their unique workflows and vocabulary.

Approach

Taliferro deployed **TODD** with a configuration tailored to siloed environments.

Containerized Architecture

Each department was assigned its own **secure container**, a concept borrowed from cloud computing and adapted for AI workflows. These containers:

- Ensured no cross-departmental data bleed.
- Could be kept isolated or toggled to interact with other containers depending on admin settings.
- Allowed department-specific policies to control how TODD retrieved, processed, and stored data.

This gave the agency the **choice** to operate independently or share data when beneficial. For example, Outreach and HR could collaborate when planning hiring campaigns—but Legal could remain fully isolated.

Permission-Based Prompting

Each container had role-based access control (RBAC), meaning:

- Prompts and data sources were scoped to the user's department.
- Admins could control which datasets, policies, or files TODD referenced in its responses.
- Sensitive departments like Legal and Finance had visibility into their own containers only.

Prompting Tools Built-In

TODD included a set of embedded tools designed to improve the prompt experience:

- **Prompt Templates**: Reusable frameworks for tasks like policy summaries, data reviews, email drafts, and report writing.
- **Prompt History Analyzer**: Suggested revisions based on prior outputs that didn't hit the mark.
- **Prompt Testing Sandbox**: Let users test phrasing before it touched production data.
- **Auto-Tuning**: The system learned from successful prompts and began pre-optimizing similar requests.

Lessons Learned

Tips & Tricks

Creating High-Quality Prompts in TODD Unlike other AI platforms that leave users guessing, TODD offered built-in prompt support. Here are key techniques users learned:

- **Be Specific About Output Type**: Asking for "a 2-paragraph executive summary" produced more usable content than a vague "summarize this."
- **Use Context Links**: Embedding file names, policy IDs, or dataset references helped TODD's Contextual Insight Mapping (CIM) deliver grounded results.
- **Avoid Overstuffing**: Users were taught to avoid asking multiple questions at once, allowing TODD's Precision-Driven Heuristics (PDH) to focus on a single high-value task.
- **Use Prompt Templates**: These created consistency across departments and reduced the learning curve.

Results and Impact

- **100% Compliance**: No unauthorized cross-departmental data access occurred after TODD deployment.
- **Reduced Output Time**: Departments saw an average **68% reduction** in time to generate key documents.
- **Improved Accuracy**: Prompting success rate increased by **82%** thanks to embedded tips, testing, and template use.
- **Flexible Governance**: The agency could update rules and visibility settings without needing new software.

Legal reported peace of mind knowing their content would never be mixed with other teams. HR saw quicker onboarding docs. Finance used TODD's Consistent Output Protocol (COP) to generate repeatable budget summaries. Outreach used cross-container collaboration with HR to align hiring with outreach cycles.

Why It Matters

This case illustrates how TODD isn't just a chatbot—it's a **department-aware AI platform**. While tools like Co-pilot exist inside shared cloud suites with minimal structural control,

TODD provides:

- Infrastructure-level data separation
- Governance by container, user, and prompt
- Prompting tools that make AI usable, not experimental

By combining flexible architecture with embedded prompt intelligence, TODD made AI safe, effective, and truly department-ready.

Conclusion

Agencies shouldn't have to choose between AI power and data privacy. With TODD, they get both. Taliferro Tech built TODD not just to answer questions—but

to respect boundaries, teach better prompting, and evolve with the people using it.

That’s the difference between a plugin and a platform.